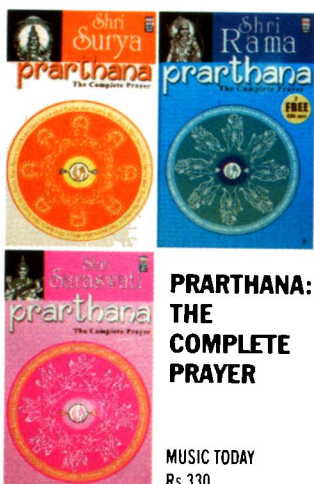


music

De-stress Mantra



Mantras help one to meditate and reinforce positive thoughts in one's life. Apart from relaxing one's mental being, each mantra if repeated, addresses specific needs. "Mantras when sung have a healing effect," says vocalist Pandit Jasraj, who starts his concerts with a chant. While bhajans have always been popular, traditional chants have hopped up the charts. Some musical groups have also experimented with mantras from religious texts by giving them a lounge-like feel.

Prarthana is a series of 10 double volume mainstream devotional albums

composed by santoor maestro Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma and the master of the bamboo flute Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia. Every double CD album is a compendium of Gayatri, Kavach, Stotras, Chalisa, Namavali, Aarti, Kshama prarthana and much more. Each album is a dedication to a deity and encompasses all aspects of daily prayers.

The albums are high on melody with singers like Suresh Wadkar, Ravindra Sathe, Shekhar Sen, Sadhna Sargam, and Devki Pandit chanting different mantras. The series has been exhaustively researched through guidance on text and pronunciation by Sanskrit scholar Vachaspati Maudgalya. What makes it different from other chant albums is the contemporary treatment and an attractively packaged booklet.

The series includes prarthanas such as Shri Ganesh, Shri Rama, Shri Gayatri, Shri Saraswati and Shri Surya composed by Sharma, while those for Shri Krishna, Shri Shiva, Shri Vishnu, Shri Durga and Shri Hanuman have been composed by Chaurasia. Hum along and relieve your stress.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

Chaurasia (left) and Sharma turn to mantras



YASBANT NEGI



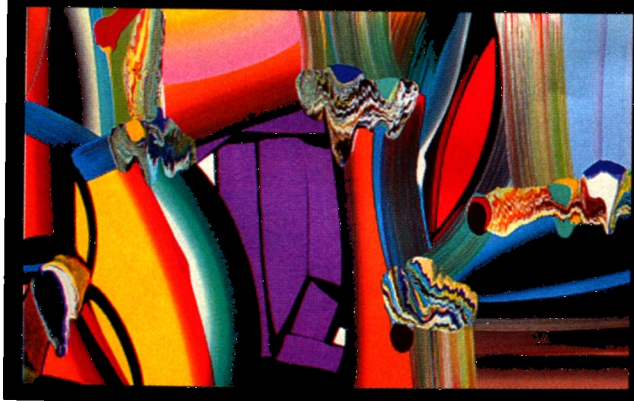
YASBANT NEGI

Riot of Colours

'Kaleidoscope' by Chennai's Ayya Art Galleries presents a bright fusion of art works from 55 Indian artists. "It is a unity of talents and artistic expressions on various surfaces from various parts of India, like a kaleidoscope," says Kanalan Raja, curator of the exhibition. The works reflect a combination of varied media—water colours, oil on canvas, acrylic, paper collages and etching. Venkatesh Pate's black and white work stands alongside Nitish Bhattacharjee's multi-hued abstract painting and Yogesh Rawal's paper collage in red, black and yellow. Jyotee Kolte's acrylic on canvas comes in earthy browns and yellows while Bose Krishnamachari's work is a synthesis of bright colours. Alphonso Arul Doss has presented a figurative work on canvas. Smriti Dixit has a mixed media on canvas and Mumbai's Vilas and Jinsook Shinde's abstracts are a riot of colours. Other participating artists are Aditya Basak, B.V. Suresh, Srinivasa Chari, Laxma Goud, Narendra Babu, Smriti Dixit and R. Baala. Till June 13 at The Fourth Floor, Kitab Mahal.

by Aditi Pai

The exhibition is a canvas of talents and expressions



art

Mixed Ware

DELHI Online sale of art is catching up. The Bodhi FIVE online sale features a mix of artists ranging from masters like S.H. Raza, Ganesh Haloi, Jogen Chowdhury and Paritosh Sen with other contemporaries like Sheetal Gattani,

S. Harsha Vardhana, Chittrovanu Mazumdar and Bose Krishnamachari. Photography is included with works by Prabir

Purkayastha and Prabuddha Das Gupta.

The lineup is curated bearing in mind the preference of collectors who in a single session can view an array of contemporary and modern Indian art. On till July 4.

